GRADE 11 / Business Studies / English

Turn a challenge into an action plan

01 Understand

Learning goals: Separate a symptom from a cause • Compare practical alternatives • Plan implementation and evaluation

Problem solving begins by defining a specific problem and gathering evidence. A fall in sales is a symptom until its causes are investigated.

Generate alternatives before selecting one. Compare likely benefits, costs, time and risks instead of choosing the first idea.

Implementation needs an owner, deadline and measurable result. Review evidence afterwards and adjust if the solution does not work.

A structured problem-solving cycle

Stage	Question	Example evidence
Define	What is going wrong?	20 late orders this week
Investigate	What causes it?	stock-outs on 15 orders
Act and review	Did the change help?	late orders after new stock rule

02 Follow the reasoning

A small business has 20 late orders, 15 caused by stock-outs. Recommend a justified first intervention.

1. The evidence points to stock availability as the main measured cause, not necessarily unmotivated staff.

2. Compare a reorder-level system with holding much more stock. The first may reduce cash tied up but needs accurate records.

3. Assign the stock controller a two-week trial and compare the late-order count, while checking demand changes.

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Practise with purpose

03 Try before checking

Use paper or your notebook. Show your reasoning. For written responses, use evidence and explain your choices. Suggested time: 15–20 minutes.

1. Why should customer complaints be analysed before selecting a solution?

2. Give one disadvantage of carrying excess stock.

3. Name a measurable indicator for a trial delivery improvement.

04 Check and correct

1. To identify patterns and causes instead of guessing from isolated symptoms.

2. It ties up cash and risks damage, obsolescence or storage costs.

3. Percentage of orders delivered on time over a stated period, compared with a baseline.

Common mistake to avoid

A recommendation without a responsible person, time frame or success measure is incomplete as an action plan.

Reflect and revisit

Identify one correction in your own words. Attempt a similar question tomorrow without looking at the guide. If you are still unsure, take your attempt to a teacher or tutor.

Coverage and sources

CAPS topic focus: Business ventures: creative thinking and problem solving

DBE CAPS, Grades 10–12: Business Studies. Section 3 content and skills. This is a focused supplement, not a complete syllabus or prescribed literature replacement.

Open the official DBE curriculum reference

Content and visuals: original SmartBridge FET. AI-assisted authoring; subject-teacher and language-specialist review pending. Report an issue with the pack ID bst-11.